

OREGON CITY COURIER

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SOMETHING WRONG

Something is so radically wrong with conditions at the Oregon City high school that "something" is out of place. An evil condition exists and in justice to pupils and to parents of pupils action is necessary. Of all places on the face of the earth where evil conditions should be unknown quantities, that place is the school system. Oregon City, through her high school, is setting an untoward example to the other schools of the county and of the state, in place of being a model for them to copy. The city and the county have reason for shame, and to avoid more of that should remedy conditions at once.

Whether the fault lies with the teaching staff as a whole or whether the city school superintendent is at fault, The Courier does not attempt to say, but it does say that the elements at fault should be thrown out bodily. The school superintendent was charged and tried in the circuit court recently under very unpleasant circumstances, and the agitation against him has not ceased. There exists a difference of opinion as to the source of the trouble in the local institution. Some are as positive that the superintendent is culpable as others are certain that members of the faculty are picking petty bones. But wherever the charge finds a base the public is entitled to know the truth and has a right to demand that the school board expel at once the element guilty of the contention that is raising its smell to the skies.

If the remedy requires casting out the city superintendent, and charges against him are substantiated, he should be thrown out in such rapid style that his hair would singe. The Courier does not blame the superintendent, nor does it accuse any member of the teaching staff, but it would like to know the truth. If the teaching staff is at fault the members should be discharged before the evil influence of their presence has further polluted the young human stream that is moulding in their charge.

Find the truth if it takes an investigation to South Africa to establish the blame, and then kick, say we. And while kicking, kick so hard that the example of the treatment accorded inharmonious elements in the school system of Oregon City will be such that no one person or any dozen will dare to trifle with the sanctity of education and with the order of the public school system in the community.

That these stinking quarrels have found expression in the high school staff shows that there is friction in the educational wheels. That friction must be greased up immediately by throwing out the elements that do not work in absolute harmony and to the proper interests of pupils and patrons.

Parents are paying dearly for the educational facilities provided for their children in the local high school, and they are entitled to know how the school is run, or why it is not properly conducted. They are entitled to a reasonable guarantee of the proper expenditure of the funds which their tax payments create, but they are not getting it under present conditions. Fighting among the teachers and officials, the wholesale resignation of teachers, circuit court trials and such things are not what parents are paying for. They are paying teachers and officials to work on a common ground for the best interests of the young folks entrusted to their care, and when the school forces stoop to bantering and quarreling, and fail to find a common ground for their labors, then the parents should take a hand.

Parents, pupils, school board and the side which is in the right in the present high school muddle should demand an immediate hearing and settle the trouble before they turn the wrong side of the fight bottom side up and kick it into the middle of the cesspool of oblivion, where it rightly

belongs, with the good boot of fair play. Fair play for both sides in the squabble demands an investigation and the prompt ejection of the elements at fault.

A DIM LIGHT

If the democratic slate is as badly broken up as is the chain of thought of that journalistic what-not, The Enterprise, then heaven help the party. Without denying a single statement made by The Courier, and resorting to ridicule of democracy, persons at institutions in its yellow-livered attempt at a come-back, the omniscient Enterprise continues its distorted and very childish arguments in connection with the shriveling situation.

As far as The Courier is able to determine the democratic party is fearful in its regret that Maxwell Victor did not discuss with The Enterprise his intention of filing for office, before he shocked that incongruous sheet by his action. It is too bad, indeed, that the democratic party was so thoughtless as to leave the esteemed Enterprise out of the councils of war. It is almost unbearably sad to know that The Enterprise could not keep Victor from throwing a great gob of fear into republican hearts by doing a thing which will tend to bring democrats to strict attention, and thereby do much to cause Victor's defeat at the primaries.

Can it be that the dictatorial old mouthpiece of defamation has lost its punch? Can it be that the petty scandalizer has lost its grasp upon republican affairs and is trying, as a last, lonesome chance, to stick its grimy digits into the democratic pie? Surely not! That "mourning" indigestible cannot be the hopeless scarecrow that its editorials lead us to believe it. After fifty weary years on the wrong side of the fence is that ancient oracle of privilege, that journalistic rake, seeing the defeat of its party and principals? Is it seeing in E. T. Mass, or another good democrat the successor to its incumbent in the sheriff's office? Does it discredit the democratic party, howl "shattered slate" and childishly pull at the harp strings of foolishness because it sees a cloud on its own horizon?

At any rate the arguments it puts forth are as ridiculously simple as its absent-minded publication of fake interviews was amusing. When a newspaper gets to that stage where it must resort to fakes and wanton subterfuges to carry its mistakes into the minds of its readers certainly some awful calamity is about to befall it. The Enterprise did resort to fake interview and its cheapened itself, even more than it was already cheapened, by resorting to nasty personalities. The Enterprise concedes its reprehensible methods, the fallacy of its arguments and its yellow-livered style when it dodges the issue and stoops to ridicule.

Like a pup with a can tied to its tail The Enterprise stands up on its wobbly legs to give one last weak bark, and then runs round corners of fancy and distortion in order to avoid answering in upright fashion for its "interviews" with "prominent" democrats. The men named by that paper as leaders of the democratic party in this county absolutely deny being interviewed regarding Victor's candidacy. They absolutely deny that they see any "shattered slate," or that they see the election of Victor merely because his name is to be printed on the ballot. In spite of these statements by Mr. Mass, Mr. Jack and Mr. Hedges, The Enterprise, which invariably gets facts crosswise in its ignorance, says: "The Enterprise does not budge from its position that the democratic party are in a state of near panic every time the sheriff's office is mentioned."

We respectfully call the school teacher's attention to the "party are." The grammatical and political education of our beloved contemporary has been sadly neglected during the last fifty years.

The wobbly and bearded old jaur-

nalistic riff-raff hasn't a foot left upon which to stand the emaciated carcass of its argument. Its ignorance is a mighty handicap to proper thinking and its editorial ravel is like a sieve. "Let the republicans rejoice!"

THE PRIMARIES

The Courier does not pretend to say that Maxwell Victor will not be nominated at the primary election next week. The Courier does say that sentiment in the party is against Victor because of his peculiar entry into the race at the eleventh hour and because of several other things, notable among which is the fact that he is not a taxpayer in this county and therefore has no license to guard the money of the taxpayers should he be elected to the sheriff's office.

There is one way to keep Victor from getting the nomination, and that is to write in the name of E. T. Mass, the only other democratic possibility for the office. If the party does not want Victor to receive the nomination, then the party must be as a man in writing in the name of Mass, who served the county as sheriff for two terms and established during that time an enviable record of achievement and attention to duty.

Mr. Mass is not making a personal campaign as he is not a candidate, but he will accept the nomination if it is tendered to him. Therefore, it behooves those who have complained about the possibility of the nomination of Victor to rally to the Mass standard. There is only one side to the question: If Victor is nominated the election of the republican nominee is assured. If Mass is nominated the election of the republican nominee will be possible only by the fullest exercise of the republican franchise.

How do you know that his dirty face wouldn't beam with pure delight if it were washed clean? How do you know that he isn't far more a man than you were at his age? Yet you pass him without even a sign of recognition. You know that your kind word might go a long way toward bringing the joy of a young soul to the surface, might accomplish great things with a young mind and heart, but you are forgetful. The youngster is not. He never forgets his childhood days.

Maybe you were battered a little too severely by a cold world when you were a lad, and more is the reason why you should aid the little chaps about you. Your influence might lead them into worthy lives, and your kindly assistance might make real men of the little fellows who would otherwise be a dreadful burden upon the society which creates them.

When you have made a friend of one of these urchins, be his station high or low, you have something that should be cherished far more than the more mature friendships that you make. The latter are too often friendships of profit, but the friendship of the little tad on the street is real and true and comes from the bottom of an innocent heart. Surely the regard of a kid has its value. Cultivate the regard of the little folks and you'll not only help them but you'll be a better soul yourself, your disposition and your appetite will improve and you will see much more of the beauty of life.

TURN ABOUT

Turn about is fair play unless the government is involved. At least that seems to be the erroneous opinion firmly rooted in the minds of the rail-

money for their labor, and the railroads, which are hampered and treated most unjustly by the public and the government, cannot see just why the people shouldn't pay twice its value for the land in the O. & C. allotment.

A BIG IDEA

"Were Woodrow Wilson a republican president, with a record of achievement identical with his record as a democratic president, the republicans would renominate him by acclamation," says the New York World.

"They would point to the revision of the tariff under his administration as the fulfillment of McKinley's dying pledge, which Roosevelt shirked and in which Taft failed.

"They would point to the banking and currency law as the greatest piece of financial legislation yet enacted—a law which has made it possible for the United States not only to weather successfully the most devastating war in human history, but to aspire to the financial mastery of the world.

"They would point to the income-tax law as a just and equitable means of making wealth bear its due proportion of the cost of government, for which the republican party was entitled to a double share of credit because a republican congress had submitted the amendment to the constitution which made the levying of an income tax possible.

"They would point to the president's Mexican policy, identical as it is with Lincoln's Mexican policy, as evidence that the American people were no less determined than ever to give the backward nations of this hemisphere the fullest opportunity to work out their destiny, and finally

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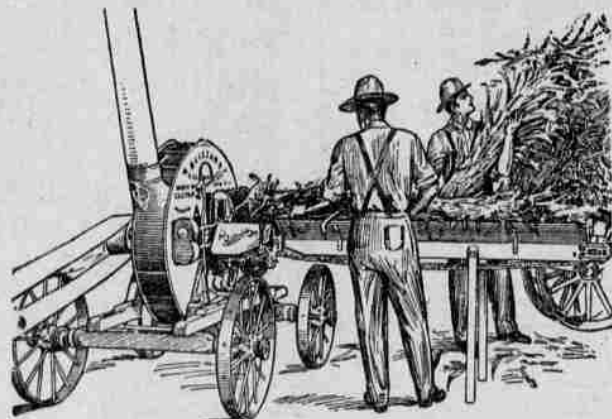
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The situation is in the hands of the voters of the democratic party. If they want to insure the election of a republican sheriff this fall they may vote for Victor, and the election will be insured. But, on the other hand, if they want a real democratic candidate for sheriff, and the only receptive possibility at the present time who can defeat the republican nominee, they will write in the name of E. T. Mass on the primary ballot and at the general election there will be no necessity for apologies.

THE REGARD OF A KID

Someone has said that even the regard of a kid has its value. But whoever said it didn't go quite far enough. He should have said that the regard of a child is about the most blessed token man can have.

How few of us think of the value of the friendship of a child. We pass the ragged urchin in the street sometimes even scornfully, and he, if he happens to know you, sinks down into his clothes like a criminal and slumps on past as if to escape from a judgment of fate. That same ragged urchin, with the proper training, the proper clothing and the proper environment might be timber for the biggest position in the land. He was endowed with a heart, even as you and I, and his brain is of the same capacity, except that it must be moulded by the loving hand of friendship.

road managements of the United States and especially of Oregon.

Since the laborers on the railroads of the country have started action to gain higher wages the transportation companies have been sending out great wads of literature in an attempt to show that the increase in wages asked for by the men is an unjust hardship upon the employing companies, and they ask for its general condemnation by the people of this country. The companies accuse the government and the people of huge injustice.

Meanwhile the Oregon-California land grant business is still before the court with the railroad companies bucking every possible solution where by they will not get the lion's share of the division of spoils.

The government expressly provided for the sale of the O. & C. lands by the railroad to actual settlers at \$2.50 an acre. Nearly two and a half millions of acres of this land have been tied up by the railroad company, and it refuses to sell at so low a figure as \$2.50 an acre. The railroad insists upon selling the land back to the government at double the amount of its equity. That is a shady attempt to bleed the public through the government and to profit the railroad company to the extent of some \$5,000,000.

How beautifully is the public showing its unjust side to the railroads. The dear public cannot see just why railroad employees shouldn't get more

achieve that liberty under law which even the most enlightened of peoples have had to gain by struggle and sacrifice.

"They would point to his preparedness measures as full atonement for past derelictions on the part of the republican party, and as an example of leadership that knows how, in times of national peril, to bring irreconcilable political elements into harmony for the public welfare.

"They would point to the administration of Wilson as second only to the administration of Washington and Lincoln in the record of mighty achievement in behalf of the American people.

"No other nation with a leader like Woodrow Wilson would be crazy enough in the midst of a world crisis to change or to tolerate any attempt to bring about a change. We know of no reason why the American people should be less sane than other people, or why they should permit their vital interest to be bedevilled for the edification of ambitious professional politicians.

"Republican politicians talk much about patriotism, American prestige and the national honor. Do they believe what they say? If so, they ought to welcome the chance to nominate President Wilson. That would be a supreme manifestation of patriotism. It would strengthen American prestige in every capital of the world as nothing else could do. It would put the national honor beyond

the possibility of stain. It would reveal to civilization a united republic, eager for peace, unafraid of war and determined to maintain the glorious traditions of service to mankind which it inherited from the Fathers.

"What say you, gentlemen of the republican convention? Is the party whose proud boast is that it saved the Union great enough and patriotic enough to help give to American democracy a new Union in this day when civilization itself is hanging crucified on a cross of European imperialism?"

WHAT CAN MONEY DO?

This is the pertinent question that has been presented to a University of Chicago professor for solution. Although a theorist, which any college professor must be to a certain extent, would not, perhaps, have the best ideas in the world as to what money can do, this particular professor must find the power of money within the next year.

He has been given \$1000 and he is to use it where the maximum good will be accomplished. How would you do it? The Courier would enjoy hearing from some of its readers their plans for disposing, within one year, of \$1000, placing every cent of it where it would accomplish the greatest good. But the same question is puzzling the professor who has the duty of solution before him. The fact that popular fiction presents a system for disposing of one million dollars within a year would make the judicious expenditure of \$1000 seem a simple matter. Can you tell the professor how to do it?

The man into whose hands has been put \$1000 to spend in one year, accomplishing therewith the greatest possible good, is a broad minded, well educated and whole hearted man. He is not a politician. He is thoroughly acquainted with the ordinary uses of money, for in these busy days college professors are paid well for their work. He knows what charity can do with money, and he realizes that there must be better ways to spend \$1000 than thru the channels offered

by charity in its present organized form. The professor knows that to do things for people is not one-half so great and gracious as to teach people to do for themselves. Human abilities are too cramped in the bustle of modern times; human ingenuity does not enjoy its proper extended bounds, and it is possible that the professor will devise a way of spending his \$1000 so that new human abilities and new capabilities will be liberated to the eternal benefit of mankind.

The Chicago professor has much the same question to answer as was answered by Henry George in an open letter to Pope Leo, says one writer:

"The question was, 'What can the rich man do to improve the condition of labor?' George reviewed, in answer, all possible ways of spending money philanthropically, such as giving alms, building churches and schools, establishing hospitals, building model tenements, encouraging science, helping emigration, selling or renting land below the market price, and beautifying the city. In each case his unanswerable logic led him to the same conclusion. None of these suggestions touched the fundamental cause of poverty and distress, monopolization of land. The result in each case would consequently be to injure some as much as others were helped. So, in the end, he could only say this of what the rich man could do:

"He can do nothing at all except to use his strength for the abolition of the great primary wrong that robs men of their birthright. The justice of God laughs at the attempts of men to substitute anything else for it."

Can the Chicago professor, with his mere \$1000, find a better solution to the problem than did Henry George? Is there a better solution? If there is perhaps some reader of The Courier has struck the happy thought and can enlighten a world that is in darkness as to the real power of money; a world that would willingly give many times \$1000 to know how to free the covered abilities, the submerged ambitions and capacities of our man.

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